

INVERSION

What is Inversion ?

Normally the word order of the sentence is '**Subject + Verb**' but when the verb is placed ahead of the subject i.e '**Verb + Subject**' it is known as INVERSION.

Example :-

- **Normal Sentence:** You are tired. (**Subject + Verb**)
- **Inversion:** Are you tired? (**Verb + Subject**)

The main purpose of using the inversion is **to emphasize what you are saying or writing**. It is most commonly used in **Question Forms**. However there are few other circumstances also where we use **inversion**.

Types of Sentences where we use inversion are as follows :-

TYPE 1 :- In Interrogative Sentences:

Interrogative sentences generally are of the following structure:

Auxiliary Verb + Subject + Main Verb

Examples :-

- **Did** he go to the office ?
- Where **is** the book ?

TYPE 2 :- In the sentences where the 'Adverbial Expression of Place' is at the beginning of the sentence, or if the sentence begins with "here, there, in, out, up, down, etc", we follow inversion.

Examples :-

- **Normal Sentence:** All the books we had lost were on the table.
Inversion: **On the table** were all the books we had lost.
- **Normal Sentence:** So many students are there in that class.
Inversion: **There** are so many students in that class.
- **Normal Sentence:** A boy is standing in front of the shop.
Inversion: **There** is a boy standing in front of the shop.
- **Inversion:** **Here** comes the train.
- **Inversion:** **Up** goes the Sensen.

TYPE 3 :- In the Conditional Sentences which do not have conjunctions.

Examples :-

- **Normal Sentence:** If he had been there, he would have seen it.
Inversion: Had he been there, he would have seen it.
- **Normal Sentence:** If I were a teacher, I would teach mathematics.
Inversion: Were I a teacher, I would teach mathematics.

TYPE 4 :- In the sentences which start with **Negative Adverbials** like "**Hardly, Rarely, Barely, Scarcely, Seldom, etc.**" or with "**No, Not, Never, Not Only, No sooner**". Such sentences are always in the "Inversion" type.

Examples :-

- **Inversion:** **Seldom** does the teacher finish her class early.
- **Inversion:** **No sooner** had we arrived home than the neighbour rang the doorbell.
- **Inversion:** **Never** in the history of Cricket, did we see such a close encounter.
- **Inversion:** **Not only** does he work there, but also his friends.

TYPE 5 :- In the sentences that follow the structure: " So + adjectivethat....."

Examples :-

- **Normal Sentence:** I was so angry that nobody could talk to me.
Inversion: So angry was I that nobody could talk to me.
- **Normal Sentence:** She was so tired that she was unable to get up.
Inversion: So tired was she that she was unable to get up.

TYPE 6 :- There are some common phrases that will be followed by inversion like- "In no way, on no account, under no circumstance,

at no time, to such a degree, to such an extent, only, etc."

Examples :-

- **Only** yesterday did I go for a movie.
- **Under no circumstance** does she get the incentive.
- **At no time** did the institute do anything wrong.
- **In no way** do I agree with what she is saying.
- **Only later** did he think about the situation.

TYPE 7 :- In exclamatory sentences, inversion can occur for emphasis or to convey surprise or strong emotion.

Examples :-

- How beautiful is the scenery!
- What a wonderful performance she gave!

TYPE 8 :-

In formal or literary contexts, "should" can be used to indicate hypothetical situations. Here, "should" is placed before the subject.

Examples :-

- Should you need any assistance, feel free to ask.

Practice Exercise

Spot the Error :-

Direction :- In the sentences given below, check if the 'inversion' is properly implemented, and if not then correct the sentence accordingly:

- Q.1. (a) We rarely do witness /(b) such a breathtaking sunset /(c) in this part of the country /(d) no error.
- Q.2. (a) Little she knew /(b)that her life /(c)was about to change forever /(d) no error.
- Q.3. (a) Only after the storm had passed /(b) they realized the extent /(c) of the damage /(d) no error.
- Q.4. (a) Not until he lost /(b) everything did he truly /(c) appreciate what he had /(d) no error.
- Q.5. (a) Seldom have I /(b) encounter such kindness /(c) from strangers /(d) no error.
- Q.6. (a) Under no circumstances /(b) should you attempt to /(c)climb that mountain alone /(d) no error.
- Q.7. (a) Nowhere else in the /(b) can world you find /(c) such unique cultural diversity /(d) no error.
- Q.8. (a) Only with patience /(b) and perseverance can /(c) one achieved true mastery/(d) no error.
- Q.9. (a) Not only she won /(b) the competition, but she /(c) also set a new record /(d) no error.
- Q.10. (a) Hardly had I began /(b) my journey when I /(c) encountered my first obstacle/(d) no error.
- Q.11. (a) Never before /(b) I have seen such a /(c) magnificent piece of artwork /(d) no error.
- Q.12. (a) Rarely a film has left /(b) such a lasting /(c) impression on me /(d) no error.
- Q.13. (a) Only by working /(b) together can we overcome /(c) these challenges /(d) no error.
- Q.14. (a) Not until he spoke /(b) I realized the gravity /(c) of the situation /(d) no error.
- Q.15. (a) Little did they suspect /(b) that their simple act of kindness /(c) will make such a difference /(d) no error.
- Q.16. (a) Under no circumstances you /(b) ignore /(c) your health /(d) no error.
- Q.17. (a) Nowhere else you can /(b) experience the beauty /(c) of nature like you can here /(d) no error.
- Q.18. (a) Only with dedication /(b) and hard work /(c) one can achieve their dreams /(d) no error.

Q.19. (a) Not until he retired /(b) he had the opportunity /(c) to travel the world /(d) no error.

Q.20. (a) Only when the /(b) guests had arrived did /(c) we start preparing the dinner /(d) no error.

Answers With Explanation :-

Spot the Error

Sol.1.(a) Replace "We rarely do" with "rarely do we".

Sol.2.(a) Replace "she knew" with "did she know".

Sol.3.(b) Replace "they realized" with "did they realize".

Sol.4.(d) no error.

Sol.5.(b) Replace "encounter" with "encountered". The third form of the verb is used with the helping verb 'have'.

Sol.6.(d) no error.

Sol.7.(b) Replace "can world you" with "world can we".

Sol.8.(c) Replace "achieved" with "achieve".

Sol.9.(a) Replace "she won" with "did she win".

Sol.10.(a) Replace "began" with "begun". The third form of the verb is used with 'had'.

Sol.11.(b) Replace "I have" with "have I".

Sol.12.(a) Replace "a film has" with "has a film".

Sol.13.(d) no error.

Sol.14.(b) Replace "I realized" with "did I realize". 'Not until he spoke' is a negative expression of time, so we will use inversion after it.

Sol.15.(c) Replace "will" with "would". Past form 'would' is used for a sentence that is in the past tense.

Sol.16.(a) Add "should" after circumstances. Modal 'should' is used after the expression 'under no circumstances'.

Sol.17.(a) Replace "you can" with "can you".

Sol.18.(c) Replace "one can" with "can one".

Sol.19.(b) Replace "he had" with "did he have". 'Not until he retired' is a negative expression of time, so we will use inversion after it.

Sol.20.(d) no error.